

Zombie USMCA will endure through Trump's term

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【要点】

- ・トランプ政権下で「ゾンビUUSMCA」（三国間の新協定なく、米国の関税除外が続く状況）が継続する可能性が80%と見込まれている。
- ・米国とメキシコは年内に自動車と鋼鉄部門の関税救済を提供する限定的な貿易協定を締結する可能性が65%であるが、カナダとの協定は政治情勢から2026年中の実現が困難である。
- ・自動車製造は北米で最も統合されたセクターであり、米国のカナダとメキシコへの関税政策が異なるリスクが最も高い。
- ・USMCA全体の三国間協定更新は尾部リスク（10%確率）であり、トランプ政権は関税レバレッジを保持したいため、現状を変える政治的インセンティブがない。
- ・カナダとメキシコはCPTPP（環太平洋戦略的経済連携協定）を二国間自由貿易の代替手段として活用し、限定的な二国間協定を通じて関税削減を引き続き追求する。

【メール原文】

The Zombie USMCA scenario will persist through the Trump administration (80% probability) . Eurasia Group has warned since May 2025, including in Top |||

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A "Zombie USMCA" scenario, with no new trilateral agreement and continued exemptions under the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) from US Section 301 tariffs, is likely to persist through the rest of President Donald Trump's term.

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The US and Mexico are likely to conclude a limited trade deal that would provide relief from US sectoral tariffs on autos and steel (65% odds) by year's end; however, a US-Canada agreement in 2026 remains unlikely (40%), given the political conditions in both countries, although a major escalation is also unlikely.

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Auto manufacturing, the most integrated sector in North America, faces the highest risk of US tariff divergence between Canada and Mexico in our basecase; elsewhere, North American trade integration will likely continue broadly unchanged, with Ottawa and Mexico City able to rely on the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) as a bilateral free trade backstop.

The Zombie USMCA scenario will persist through the Trump administration (80% probability). Eurasia Group has warned since May 2025, including in Top Risks 2026 , that trilateral USMCA negotiations

were likely to enter a “zombie” state. That meant no trilateral deal to renew and extend the agreement, triggering an annual review process, tariff exemptions for USMCA-compliant goods not subject to US Section 232 tariffs, and bilateral US negotiations with Canada and Mexico. Ottawa and Mexico City would seek sectoral tariff reductions. The US announcement on 1 July 2026 that it would not agree to renew and extend the existing agreement formalized that scenario. It is now likely to endure through the Trump administration, with the White House facing no strong political incentives to change the status quo.

A trilateral deal to renew USMCA is highly unlikely, as is the agreement’s demise. Both scenarios are tail risks, each with a probability of 10%. Only a formal agreement among the three parties can renew and extend USMCA for an additional 16 years from the time of their deal, and none of the governments likely want to box themselves in for that long. The Trump administration wants to preserve its tariff leverage, while Ottawa and Mexico City anticipate more constructive negotiations with Trump’s successor. At the same time, the US is unlikely to either formally withdraw from USMCA or execute a de facto exit via the removal of tariff exemptions for most USMCA-compliant products, since both options could precipitate severe economic and market consequences.

Canada and Mexico will continue to seek tariff reductions through limited bilateral deals. However, these negotiations will not directly affect the broader status of USMCA. Ottawa and Mexico City could each conclude separate, limited deals with Washington that settle bilateral trade irritants and reduce US Section 232 tariffs, but the Zombie USMCA basecase will remain intact.

The US and Canada remain unlikely to strike a limited deal in 2026 (40% odds). Trump and Prime Minister Mark Carney remain in contact, and there is hope in Ottawa that Trump’s need for a “win” before the midterm elections could catalyze a deal (see: Trade war likely to continue through US midterms , 27 August 2026). But despite a willingness to restart talks, the political choreography is challenging. Trump is unlikely to de-escalate first, while Carney cannot appear to capitulate—indeed, his high approval ratings reflect strong support for his stance toward the US. Carney, therefore, needs US concessions, most likely on Section 232 auto tariffs, to sell a limited deal domestically. However, Trump’s threat to raise auto tariffs from 25% to 50% on 1 January 2027 is likely intended as a forcing mechanism, which could create momentum to restart talks before the New Year.

A limited US-Mexico agreement is likely this year (65% odds). President Claudia Sheinbaum has a working rapport with Trump and is ignoring the most inflammatory rhetoric from US officials. This approach has helped Mexican negotiators make progress in trade talks. However, shifting US demands will limit Sheinbaum’s willingness to grant further concessions without tariff relief. A limited deal would also likely center on Section 232 tariff reductions or exemptions, especially on autos and steel. Additional reforms to Chinese market access and energy regulations are possible, but likely beyond the remit of current negotiations and contingent on lower tariffs. Sheinbaum will continue to prioritize a deal that improves business certainty in the pursuit of “least disfavored nation” status in trade with the US.

Automobile manufacturing is most exposed to tariff divergence. Autos are at the highest risk of disruption from a significant difference in US Section 232 tariff rates on Mexico and Canada. Our expectation of a limited US-Mexico deal in parallel to an ongoing US-Canada trade war implies some divergence, especially if the US raises tariffs on Canadian auto imports in January. Moreover, a limited US-Mexico deal on automotive rules of origin would further disrupt regional supply chains and add to

pressure on Canada. This divergence would likely strengthen the trend toward auto production relocation, at least at the margin (see: Auto sector most exposed in prolonged North American trade shift , 30 June 2026).

Elsewhere, North American trade integration will continue broadly unchanged. With USMCA exemptions retained, most firms doing business across the continent will face relatively low tariff exposure. Canada and Mexico also have membership of CPTPP as a bilateral free trade backstop. This continuity will ensure a high degree of integration for supply chains between the US and both partners, maintaining a semblance of regional integration.

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